



BENCHMARK REPORT

Marketing Automation Maturity Scorecard

Full benchmark guide and action framework

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About this report

This guide accompanies the Marketing Automation Maturity Scorecard at consult-ds.com/insights/marketing-automation-maturity. It provides the full benchmark methodology, dimension definitions, and the complete action framework across all four maturity levels. Use it to brief your leadership team, prioritise a governance backlog, or prepare a business case for investment.

The four maturity dimensions

The scorecard evaluates marketing automation maturity across four dimensions, each weighted by its relative impact on revenue performance.

Dimension	Weight	What it measures	Top-quartile benchmark
Data foundation	30%	Contact data quality, unified profiles, consent, and data dictionary coverage.	75%
Platform coverage	25%	MAP, CRM, bidirectional integration, and BI layer.	80%
Automation governance	25%	Change control, naming conventions, campaign ownership, and SLAs.	70%
Performance measurement	20%	Attribution model, revenue reporting, benchmarking, and A/B testing.	65%



Maturity levels explained

Reactive (0-29)

Automation is largely manual and ungoverned. Campaigns are run ad hoc with no ownership model or change control. Quick wins exist across data quality, CRM setup, and assigning a named owner.

Developing (30-54)

Some automation is in place but governance and measurement are missing. Naming conventions are inconsistent, MAP and CRM are partially connected, and attribution is absent or disputed.

Governed (55-74)

Strong foundations. Governance is in place, platforms are integrated, and reporting exists. The gap is typically attribution depth: revenue reporting relies on MQL proxies rather than closed-loop data.

Optimised (75-100)

Top-quartile performance. Governance is embedded, attribution is finance-aligned, and testing is structured. Focus shifts to AI-assisted personalisation and predictive pipeline.

What strong teams do next

Once governance is embedded and reporting is finance-aligned, the focus shifts to predictive pipeline and controlled AI-assisted personalisation.

Action framework by maturity level

Steps are sequenced by impact within each maturity level. Work through them in order. Governance foundations compound, each item makes the next one faster to implement.

Reactive teams: where to start

- 1 Audit your contact database before touching any tool. Deduplicate, standardise field formats, and validate deliverability. The audit typically reveals that 20 to 40 percent of records are unusable.
- 2 Assign a CRM owner. Even a part-time owner with a documented mandate produces measurably better data quality than a shared responsibility that nobody owns.
- 3 Implement a basic lead lifecycle: define your stages in writing, map them to CRM fields, and lock the definitions with sales before any automation is built on top.
- 4 Document a minimum viable change log. Every modification to a workflow, scoring rule, or lifecycle stage should be recorded with a date, author, and rationale before deployment.

Developing teams: close the governance gap

- 1 Enforce naming conventions across all campaigns, lists, assets, and workflows. Retroactive cleanup is expensive; a standard applied now costs hours, not weeks.
- 2 Connect MAP and CRM bidirectionally and run a weekly data sync validation. A one-way push is not an integration and will produce attribution gaps that cannot be reconciled.
- 3 Define SLAs for lead follow-up and track adherence in a weekly dashboard. Unactioned leads within 24 hours have a significantly lower conversion rate in every B2B sector.
- 4 Write a single metric definition document covering MQL, SQL, Win Rate, and CAC. Distribute it to marketing, sales, and finance, and lock a review cadence into the calendar.

Governed teams: reach revenue-level reporting

- 1 Implement a multi-touch attribution model and document its logic. Sales and finance must be in the room when the methodology is agreed, not presented to retrospectively.
- 2 Build a monthly marketing contribution report that connects campaign activity to closed revenue, not pipeline entries. The CFO should be able to read it without a glossary.
- 3 Move A/B testing from ad hoc to hypothesis-first. Every test should have a written hypothesis, a primary metric, a minimum detectable effect, and a decision protocol before launch.
- 4 Begin the CRM-to-finance reconciliation process. Map closed CRM opportunities to finance invoices monthly. The gap you find is the size of your attribution blind spot.

Optimised teams: extend the lead

- 1 Pilot AI-assisted lead scoring on a defined segment. Use historical conversion data, run for 90 days against your existing qualification criteria, and document the delta before expanding.
- 2 Build a model monitoring process. Track score distribution shifts quarterly and retrain on fresh conversion data. Models trained on stale data produce confident wrong answers.
- 3 Develop a centre of excellence model. Document your governance standards, attribution methodology, and testing process so they transfer to new team members without degrading.
- 4 Extend attribution to offline and partner-sourced revenue. Most top-quartile teams have a digital attribution model but no methodology for calls, events, or referrals.



Industry benchmark reference

The following benchmarks reflect top-quartile B2B marketing teams across mid-market and enterprise organisations. Figures are directional; regulated industries typically score lower on automation coverage and higher on governance.

Metric	Median	Top quartile
Contact data quality (usable records)	60-70%	Above 80%
MAP and CRM integration (bidirectional)	Partial sync	Full bidirectional
Governance score	40-55%	70%+
Attribution model in place	Single-touch	Multi-touch or data-driven
Marketing contribution in board reporting	MQL volume only	Revenue and CAC
A/B testing cadence	Occasional	Hypothesis-first, quarterly+
Lead to MQL conversion rate (B2B)	15-25%	25-40%
MQL to SQL conversion rate (B2B)	25-35%	35-50%
SQL to Won conversion rate (B2B)	15-25%	25-35%

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Ready to close the gap?

DS Consulting provides advisory plus implementation across CRM governance, marketing automation, revenue attribution, and IBM watsonx AI for regulated enterprises.

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